



r/TheImprovementRoom



u/Deborah_berry1 • 1d

My older brother explained discipline in a way that finally made it click. I haven't been the same since.

I've been struggling with consistency for years. Starting things and never finishing them. Making promises to myself every Sunday night and breaking them by Tuesday afternoon. I thought something was fundamentally wrong with me.

Last weekend I was venting to my older brother about it over dinner. He's 14 years older than me, runs his own business, wakes up at 5am daily, and has maintained the same workout routine for over a decade. I've always assumed he was just "built different." Wired for discipline in a way I wasn't.

Instead of giving me the usual advice about motivation or morning routines or accountability partners, he did something I didn't expect.

He grabbed a napkin and drew two circles. Pointed to the first one and said, "This is you on a good day. Motivated, energized, full of plans." Pointed to the second one and said, "This is you on a bad day. Tired, unmotivated, wanting to quit."

Then he drew a straight line connecting both circles and said, "Discipline is this line. It doesn't care which circle you're in. It just moves forward."

I nodded like I understood, but he could tell I didn't fully get it yet.

So he tried a different approach. He put down the napkin and said, "Let me ask you something. When you brush your teeth in the morning, do you have an internal debate about whether you feel like doing it?"

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I said no, obviously not.

"Do you need a motivational video to convince you to shower?"

No.

"Do you set a reminder on your phone to eat lunch?"

No.

He leaned back and said, "So you already have discipline. You just haven't decided what else deserves the same status as brushing your teeth."

That hit me differently than any productivity book or motivational speech ever has.

He explained that when he started his business, he didn't have some magical reserve of willpower. He just decided that certain actions were non-negotiable in the same way hygiene is non-negotiable. Not exciting, not optional, not dependent on mood. Just done.

"The gym isn't something I decide to do each morning," he said. "I decided once, years ago. Now it just happens the same way brushing my teeth happens. There's no daily negotiation."

Then he said something that genuinely rewired how I think about consistency: "You don't lack discipline. You just haven't promoted the right habits to non-negotiable status. Everything you struggle with is still sitting in the 'optional' category in your brain. Move it to 'automatic' and the struggle disappears."

I asked him how you actually make that shift. How do you move something from optional to automatic when your brain keeps treating it as a choice.

He said, "You do it badly for about three weeks. You don't wait until it feels natural. You just do it while it still feels

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He said, "You do it badly for about three weeks. You don't wait until it feels natural. You just do it while it still feels forced. One morning you'll realize you did it without thinking about it. That's the moment it graduated."

He compared it to driving a car. "Remember when driving required your full concentration? Every turn signal, every mirror check, every gear shift was a conscious decision. Now you drive across town while having a full conversation and eating a sandwich. The actions didn't change. Your brain just automated them."

I sat with that for a while after dinner. Didn't say much. But the next morning I woke up and went to the gym without having an internal debate about it. Not because I felt motivated. But because I decided it was no longer a question.

It's been 11 days now. Some mornings I've been tired. Some mornings I've genuinely not wanted to go. But I stopped asking myself whether I felt like it. The question isn't on the table anymore.

I wanted to share this because I think a lot of us frame discipline as something we either have or don't have. Like it's a personality trait distributed at birth. But my brother showed me it's actually just a categorization problem. We're perfectly disciplined about things we've classified as automatic. We just need to expand that category intentionally.

Try picking one habit this week and mentally promoting it from "optional" to "non-negotiable." Don't add five things. Just one. And do it badly for three weeks without giving yourself permission to debate it each day.

That napkin drawing is still in my wallet by the way. Probably will be for a while.

Btw if you find this post helpful consider checking out my [newsletter](#). I write weekly insights on how to build habits, become more attractive and grow as a man.

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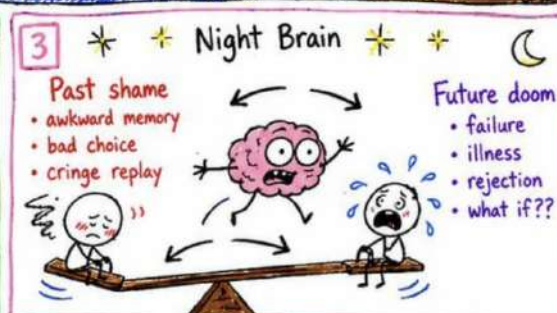
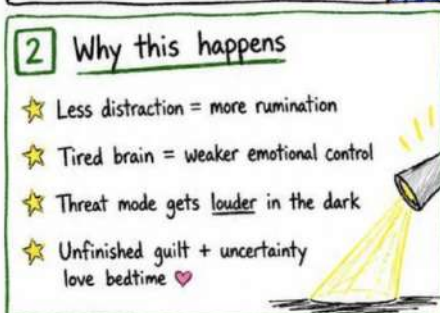
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Why Your Brain Turns Into a Regret & Disaster Machine at Night



r/DumbFact





r/Arrangedmarriage

u/RelativeLobster7699 • 1mo



Need suggestion, girl was in a live in relationship

Seeking Advice

I am 30 M from bangalore. I know I started my AM journey a bit late. We started when I was 27 but something happened where I almost died. This led me to a spiritual path, I had existential anxiety and it took me three years to find answers to my questions and to heal. My mom also got diagnosed with cancer in the meantime. It was a rough three years and now I am finally ready for marriage.

I was mentally prepared not to get hung up on the girl's past. Everybody has the right to live their life the way they want. I wasn't gonna pass on any girl on this one thing. What matters to me the most is the kind of person she is now.

Met this amazing girl through one of our relatives. She is a wonderful, kind hearted woman. She has more sense of humor than me. She is independent and free spirited. We both clicked where well, she even connected well with my sister and my parents. Families clicked well too.

My parents are financially Independent and they actually want me to live separately with my future wife. They know we need privacy and independence as newly weds.

In the last meeting, she wanted to discuss our past. I was opposed to that. Didn't want to mentally fuck myself. I told her that I only had one relationship in college, it was definitely not casual nor immature and it took a toll on me when we had to break up. I didn't want to hear about her past because I knew she had a past and it would just make me jealous and bitter.

But she insisted I know everything before we proceed. She apparently had a few boyfriends. None of them led to anything meaningful. But last relationship was different, she actually lived with her boyfriend for a year. My heart just sank, not because it was wrong but how can someone give up on someone who they lived together in the same house. I mean isn't it the same as getting divorced? And I am not to think like this?

X r/Arrangedmarriage



divorced? Am I crazy to think like this?

We ended the conversation and I didn't speak much after that and she noticed. It's been two days and I have 10 missed calls and 20 unread messages. I don't know what to do. The past was never a deal breaker for me but this is not just a past, it's a history.

I can't exactly discuss this with anyone, because I know everyone's gonna judge her. So I am posting in this sub.



77



112



125



RelationshipShot9337 MOD 1mo

AM Analyst



Locking the post because repeat topic.



← Reply



↑ Vote ↓



Amazing_Remote_7674 1mo

💖💖💖 Happily Married 🧑🏻🧑🏻💖💖

Don't marry her. You're not gonna get over it. You say that the past never mattered..but it does tho? It matters to you and that's ok..but call it as it is.

And did you ask her why that relationship ended? I hope you did before making assumptions and comparing it to a divorce.



← Reply



↑ 151 ↓



RelativeLobster7699 OP 1mo

The guy wasn't really who she thought he was. She didn't like his character once the excitement settled down. She didn't give any specifics and I didn't push her.



↑ 12 ↓



Amazing_Remote_7674 1mo

💖💖💖 Happily Married 🧑🏻🧑🏻💖💖

Valid. I'm glad you had the conversation. But I still

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**Need suggestion, girl was in a live in relationship**

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[deleted] 1mo • Comment deleted by user



[deleted] 1mo • Comment deleted by user

**Ok_Refuse_2148** 1mo

😞 Sala yeh dukh kahe khatam nahi hota be 😞

I feel you cannot say “

I was mentally prepared not to get hung up on the girl's past. Everybody has the right to live their life the way they want. I wasn't gonna pass on any girl on this one thing. What matters to me the most is the kind of person she is now. “

And still ask for a suggestion.

Pick a lane and stick to it. If you want to lie to yourself that you are a bigger human and look past the past, then be that person.

If you want to let the persons past affect your decisions then stick to that. Nothing wrong in either.

But dont stay on the fence and pick a side when convenient. Dont lie to yourself.

Good luck. I would say just let the girl know and break things up.



← Reply



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**cattywampus_y** 1mo

🏆 Top 1% Commenter

That's not an opinion. That's hypocrisy

• chatgpt probably.



3



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**snake944** 1mo

I'm not sure what's the issue here. You are trying to have your cake and eat it too. Either you are OK with a previous relationship or you are not. Commit to one. You had previous relationships before but you are not okay with this one. If it bothers you that much move on. Let the woman be. It's pretty straightforward. We are not sending people to the moon here



← Reply



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**RelativeLobster7699** OP 1mo

First of all, dating and living together are not the same. Living together is much more intimate than dating. The reason I posted is I that I really like her. I just wanted few perspectives before I made my decision. And what does that even mean, the cake thing... May be I am too old lol



3

**Intelligent_Ad_3559** 1mo

Our perspectives don't matter at all here. I would never even think about past being a factor to not go ahead with a match, someone else would never even consider anyone with a past and someone will be in between. None of that is relevant to you though.

You need to decide if you are okay with it or not. Based on all your replies and post, it appears you are not, hence most suggestions about not going ahead with this.



9

**Low_Cake_2326** 1mo

Top 1% Commenter

At least we know how many people stepped on the

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**Narrow_Box_8012** 1mo

Is everyone ignoring the fact that the guy had a past too? OP i am sorry but you're a hypocrite. There are a million reasons why a relationship doesn't work out. It's always better to leave than fall in the sunk cost fallacy and waste your life.

You had a relationship which thought was gonna work but it didn't right?



← Reply



9

**RelativeLobster7699** OP 1mo

From my pov, living together is not the same as dating. They are poles apart.



7

**cattywampus_y** 1mo

Top 1% Commenter

From my POV that's called hypocrisy



11

**understated_nuisance** 1mo

From my pov you should stop this philosophical shit and be honest with yourself



3

**Narrow_Box_8012** 1mo

They aint. Unless you were following abstinence there is no difference. Living together simply tests your compatibility with your partner which you might have been able to figure it out by simply dating.

This is the reason why a lot of couples end up in

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**scappylock** 1mo

Dont marry if you can't get over it bro



← Reply



↑ 5 ↓

**Warm-Payment-8147** 1mo

A compatible life partner can make the journey of life beautiful, while the wrong one can make it a living hell. I get your point, but first, don't leave her hanging. Please reply to her texts and calls; talk to her more. She is being honest and serious, and it's disrespectful to ignore someone's calls.

Regarding her past, you are okay with it because you have one too, but 'living together' feels like too much for you. You're right—living under one roof creates more memories than a typical past relationship; it's almost like a marriage. However, you need to ask if she is 100% over that live-in relationship.

Ask mature questions: How did it start? Why did they break up? How did she handle the aftermath, and what did she learn? Take your time to know her better. Maybe go on a trip together to see if you are truly compatible.

You might feel uneasy thinking about their past physical intimacy, so you need to honestly check if that is something you can adjust to.



← Reply



↑ 5 ↓

**superman6290** 1mo

How do I AM? 🤔

Men and women who were never married, marry men and women who are divorced all the time. So you just have to

X r/Arrangedmarriage



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means to you. Living together is not the same as marriage or divorce; it simply means they tried seriously, and it did not work.

What matters is that she chose honesty when she did not have to, and she is choosing you now. Do not let a past you were never part of ruin something that is working in the present.

Take a little time to settle your emotions, then talk to her. If it still bothers you, be honest about it, but **do not punish her for being truthful.**



← Reply



2



swathinayak 1mo

sorry, it's unrelated but, how do you get through existential anxiety



← Reply



2



RelativeLobster7699 OP 1mo • Edited

First by stabilizing the nervous system. Sometimes anxiety gets stuck in the NS, need to learn how to increase vagal tone(supplements, mineral balancing, inflammation control, sleep, exercise etc) then meditating (observing the mind without any prejudice) then contemplating the nature of our existence then core buddhists philosophy.... I mean this is what I did. Although i explored so many philosophies before landing on buddhism. Went through so many sleepless nights. Having panic attack after panic attack. one day i woke up and there was peace and clarity.



2



Beginning_Stick_8654 1mo